may retain little history. In interactional relationships, rich memory is essential—the system needs to retain and protect the evolving history of interactions. In exploitative relationships, the incentives are often misaligned with privacy, requiring strong governance and transparency to avoid abuse or regulatory violations. These distinctions are vital when building authorization policies, which must align with the true purpose and ethical boundaries of the relationship.

2.3.2 Digital relationship properties

Regardless of their nature, digital identity systems are responsible for supporting three important properties of digital relationships:

- **Integrity**—Ensuring consistent recognition of entities across interactions to maintain trust
- **Lifespan**—Managing the account lifecycle, including account creation, use, and deletion
- **Utility**—Enabling digital relationships by making information about the entity in the system available for other systems to use

Authentication systems, and their related functions, like account management, are primarily responsible for the integrity and lifespan of digital relationships. They are challenging to build, expensive to purchase and maintain, and usually the focus of digital identity discussions. Good authorization decisions depend on a good authentication system.